

Fun in the water

These marine mammals are seals. Although they come onto land to rest and to give birth, they are most at home in the water, where they perform graceful underwater acrobatics.

True seals swim by moving their back flippers from side to side.

The short front flippers are used to steer the seal.

Which are you?

Seals can be divided into two groups: true (or earless) seals and eared seals. True seals, such as these harbor seals, have no external ears.

What about eared seals?

Eared seals, such as this sea lion, have small external ears. They can also move around more easily on land and support themselves in a semi-upright position.

Eared seals have much longer front flippers than true seals.

